

WATCH-FIRST PRIMER · 45-MIN QUICK PATH · ~4 HRS FULL

The agent-native company, in ten videos.

The fastest way to get the thesis we're building on: **businesses run by AI agents, and the platform that makes that real**. Watch top-to-bottom and you'll understand what an agent is, why this is bigger than SaaS, how agents actually work, and where Merkat fits. No reading required.

THE ONE-LINE VERSION

Software is shifting from tools people operate to **agents that do the work**. Every business will run a team of them. **Merkat is where you build, run, and share that team** — the shared workspace where a company's agents live and get smarter together.

I What is it

Start here. The intellectual core — what an AI agent actually is.

IBM TECHNOLOGY · ~7 MIN

What Are AI Agents?

The cleanest plain-English explainer. If you only know the buzzword, this makes it concrete.

[Watch on YouTube](#) →

A16Z · ~30 MIN

What Is an AI Agent?

Three infra investors debate the buzziest word in tech — where the line actually sits between a chatbot and an agent.

[Watch on YouTube](#) →

ANDREJ KARPATHY · YC · ~40 MIN

Software Is Changing (Again) — “Software 3.0”

The keynote everyone references. Code → neural nets → prompts. Why English is now a programming language. This one reframes how you see the whole space.

[Watch on YouTube](#) →

II The thesis

Why this is a generational shift — and exactly the wave Merkat is built for.

YC LIGHTCONE · GARRY TAN · ~35 MIN

Vertical AI Agents Could Be 10× Bigger Than SaaS

This is basically the Merkat thesis in one video. Agents that do a job (not just software you rent) are a far bigger market than SaaS ever was.

[Watch on YouTube](#) →

SEQUOIA · AI ASCENT 2025 · ~18 MIN

AI’s Trillion-Dollar Opportunity — Keynote

The big-picture market map from the top firm in the space. Why the opportunity is 10× larger than cloud.

[Watch on YouTube](#) →

A16Z · STEVEN SINOFSKY · ~35 MIN

Software in the Age of Agents

What happens to companies and products when agents become the primary interface. Sinofsky ran Windows — he knows platform shifts.

[Watch on YouTube](#) →

NO PRIORS · BRET TAYLOR (SIERRA) · ~45 MIN

AI Agents, Outcome-Based Pricing & the OpenAI Board

The former Salesforce co-CEO on branded company agents and charging for outcomes instead of seats — the business model this whole space is moving to.

[Watch on YouTube](#) →

III How they work

Optional but worth it — the engineering reality behind good agents, straight from Anthropic.

ANTHROPIC · BARRY ZHANG · ~20 MIN

How We Build Effective Agents

The practical playbook from the team behind Claude. What separates an agent that works from one that flails.

[Watch on YouTube](#) →

ANTHROPIC · MAHESH MURAG · WORKSHOP

Building Agents with the Model Context Protocol (MCP)

MCP is how agents plug into tools and data — the open standard our whole system is wired on. This is the deep-dive.

[Watch on YouTube](#) →

ANTHROPIC · ZHANG & MURAG · ~30 MIN

Don’t Build Agents, Build Skills Instead

Directly maps to what we do: package reusable *skills* agents can share. This is the thinking behind our marketplace.

[Watch on YouTube](#) →

SHORT ON TIME? THE 45-MINUTE PATH

- 1 [IBM — What Are AI Agents?](#)
- 2 [Karpathy — Software Is Changing \(Again\)](#)
- 3 [YC / Garry Tan — Vertical AI Agents 10× Bigger Than SaaS](#)
- 4 [Anthropic — How We Build Effective Agents](#)
- 5 [Bret Taylor / Sierra — Agents & Outcome Pricing](#)

Optional, if you want more framing: a16z’s “AI Agents in 2026” and “Why AI Agents Need Context” are both good on where the space is heading — search either on YouTube.